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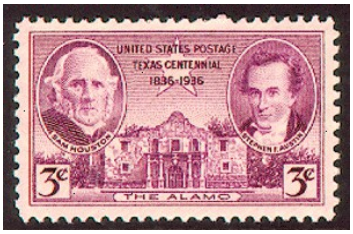
http://www.virtualstampclub.com/apstexas.html

The PHILATEX

A.P.S. Ch. # 53-0388

T.P.A. Life Ch. # 3



MEETING CALENDAR

JANUARY			FEBRUARY		
2	NO MEETING *HAPPY NEW YEAR*		6	Juniors Board of Governors Meeting Program: "Show & Tell"	6:15 pm 7:00 pm 7:30 pm
9	Juniors Board of Governors Meeting Program: "Show & Tell"	6:15 pm 7:00 pm 7:30 pm	13	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:10)	7:30 pm
16	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:10)	7:30 pm	20	Juniors Program: "UPU & Color Schemes" By Sam Rodgers	6:15 pm 7:30 pm
23	Juniors Program: "Covers to Cuero" by Richard Rose	6:15 pm 7:30 pm	27	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:00 pm
30	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:00 pm			
3/06 - Jrs, BOG, Show & Tell 3/13 - Auction 3/20 - Jrs, Program 3/27 - Bourse					

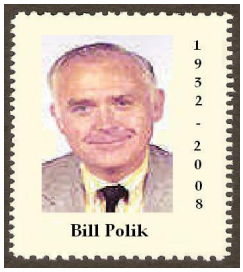
New Year's Day

EDITOR'S CORNER

LEA SENGHAAS & DORA ROBERTS

Valentine's Day

In 2008 we have said farewell to five of our members and friends. Sadly, we publish the last of our Closed Albums and also say good-by to a long-time philatelist and friend from Austin.



William Polik, an American diplomat and veteran of the Korean war, died on November 1 in San Antonio, Texas. He was 76. On completing his military service Mr. Polik enrolled in Columbia University, earning a business degree with emphasis in accounting, and upon graduation was recruited for employment with the firm Arthur Anderson in New York City. In 1958 Mr. Polik joined the United States Foreign Service and spent most of his diplomatic career overseas. He was assigned to various American Embassies abroad, where he held positions as General Services Officer in El Salvador, and as Economic and Commercial Officer in Australia, Japan, Mexico, Saudi Arabia, Malaysia, and Ghana. During his years of retirement in San Antonio, Mr. Polik, an avid reader, continued his keen interest in history and international affairs, and particularly enjoyed pursuing his hobby of stamp collecting. He was an active member of the San Antonio Philatelic Association and an enthusiastic exhibitor of collections that reflected his historical interest in the countries in which he had served.

ROMAINE FLANAGIN May 16, 1908--October 18, 2008 Romaine Flanagin was known to a number of SAPA members. She attended many of our stamp shows. Romaine was the Austin-Texas Stamp Club secretary, and exhibits chairman for the annual stamp shows for over 20 years. She was the Texas Philatelic Association (TPA) secretary for over 20 years, one of the Association's Distinguished Philatelic Texans.

Romaine and I were special friends. We always helped each other with various club duties. For 20 years she went the extra mile to make my job as TPA's editor of *The Texas Philatelist* easier. Romaine was always there when others needed help with their projects.

Jane John

PHILATEX: Editors Lea Senghaas & Dora Roberts
Labels Fred Groth
Mailing Jack Virta

The PHILATEX is published every two months and the cut off date is the 2nd Friday of the month prior to publication.

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Write to S.A.P.A. at:
San Antonio Philatelic Association
MacArthur Park Lutheran Church
2903 Nacogdoches Rd.
San Antonio, TX 78217

S.A.P.A. meets at the church every Friday night at 7:30 P.M. in building 1.

ELECTED OFFICERS:

President:	Jane K Fohn
Vice President:	Judy Grant
Secretary:	Bro. Ed Loch
Treasurer:	Fred Groth
Membership Chairman:	Dora Roberts
Communications Chairman:	Judy Grant
Historian:	Fred Groth
Auctioneer:	Jack Virta
Assistant Auctioneer:	
Librarian:	

BOARD OF GOVERNORS:

Board President:	Jane K Fohn
All Elected Officers:	(see above)
Past President:	Bob Joyce
One year term:	Pat Richmond
Two year term:	Skip Swinney
Parliamentarian:	Bob Joyce
Honorary Board Member	Richard Spies

APPOINTED:

Auditing Committee:	Tony Bir (Chairman)

LIAISON CONTACT PERSONS:

American Philatelic Society:	Fred Groth
Austin-Texas Stamp Club:	Lyle Boardman
Eire Philatelic Association:	Patrick J. Ryan
Oklahoma Philatelic Society:	Jane K Fohn
Texas Philatelic Association:	Robert J. Joyce
U.S. Postal Service:	Steve E. Canedo
APS Circuit Books	Patrick J. Ryan
Oklahoma Circuit Books	Jane K Fohn

WE WELCOME VISITORS

SAPA is always happy to welcome visitors. We hope you will enjoy our activities, and wish to join us as members.

All visitors are welcome to purchase stamps at our auctions, bourse, and bag nights. Anyone wishing to sell or trade at our meetings must be a member.

AUCTION ETIQUETTE:

Be sure to get your Bidder's number card before the auction starts. Come early and look over the lots for sale before the auction. During the auction, lots will be identified by their lot number and a brief description of the lot.

When bidding for a lot, please raise Bidder's Number card and keep it up until you no longer wish to bid. Flipping the card up and down is confusing for the auctioneers.

Please keep extraneous conversation to a minimum. This makes it easier for everyone to hear what the auctioneer is selling, and allows the auctioneer to more easily keep track of the bidding.

Please wait until the end of the auction to pay for your purchases. Your name will be called as the tallys are completed. Those who are only buying will be called first. Buyers who are also sellers will be called next. Checks are acceptable, made out to S.A.P.A.

Sellers with unsold lots should be sure to pick up their lots before leaving.

Please be sure to return the Bidder's Number cards so that we can use them again in the following auctions.

We look forward to meeting you.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE - SAPA CHRISTMAS PARTY

If you did not attend this year's SAPA Christmas party, you missed a great time! We introduced Bill Downes, from Great Britain, to Texas hospitality and cuisine--he will be on hand for show-and-tell on January 9th.

As usual, the food was outstanding. Jack Virta picked up smoked turkey and ham from the Barbecue Station--SAPA pays for the meat for the Christmas party Richard Spies, Bob Joyce and Pat Richmond chipped in to buy our traditional tamales. Lea Senghaas brought her tasty enchilada casserole. It has become a must to have Southern cornbread dressing, and Eastern bread dressing. There is no way to mention all the folks who brought their favorite dishes.

The 2009 slate of officers was voted in by acclamation. You will see very little change of officers and appointees on page 2 of the *Philatex*.

Everyone enthusiastically participated in two of quizzes. The first quiz was Pat Richmond's annual SAPA Christmas party. There was a photo gallery of everyone at the 2007 party. The answer sheet was "Whozit's Watzit?" that singled out various aspects of each attendee such as an ear, beard, shoes, hands, etc. The person had to be identified as well as what was pictured such as "Brother Loch's tie."

Since Tony Bir and his nieces were not there to lead Christmas carols, I did the best that I could. Actually my best is not to sing at all (do you remember my duet of Casey Jones?). We did "Can You Name These Christmas Carols." It was an observation exercise with 18 drawings illustrating carols, and the name of each carol had to be figured out.

Last but not least, thank you all for supporting SAPA and me during 2008. There are too many of you to list. So many of you pitch in wherever and whenever needed. Those of you who attend the meetings, your support was appreciated too. I look forward more of you joining us on Friday nights in 2009.

Jane John

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Program Notes October 24, 2008
"Philatelic Tools and Supplies: What Do You Need to Collect Stamps, Besides Stamps?"
By Judith Grant

A)

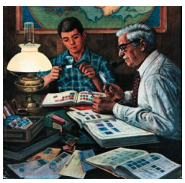
(B

Judy gave a very well organized discussion of the basics of the hobby and mechanics of stamp collecting. She covered: 1) Handling stamps, 2) Identifying Stamps, 3) Catalogs, 4) Presenting and Storing Stamps as well as ways of organizing your stamps.

One of my favorite panels of her handout was the following one which speaks of organization. Yes, folks, there are actually those people who organize rather than just accumulate.

Organization is Critical!

- Glassines
- Envelopes
- Stock Books
- Binders with Vario Pages
- Wish Lists*



In fact, some people are well enough organized to use computer technology as a tool for organizing:

Computer Technology
Organizing Your Inventory

- Excel Spreadsheets (Microsoft Office)
- Access Databases (Microsoft Office)
- Commercial Databases
- Downloadable Albums (APS (free); www.stampalbums.com (subscription))

Judy spoke of some "Homespun Tools"

Homespun Tools

- Sponges
- Systems for drying stamps
- Talcum to deal with sticky residue
- Zip-lock bags of all sizes
- Post-it Notes

Not included on the above list was a rotary cutter (pictured in B with Judy's hand) which I thought was a nice "cross-discipline" touch for those of us who are familiar with quilting. She said that she found it useful in cutting mounts. Good Idea, Judy.

Judy warned us about some dangers in stamp collecting:

NO

- Rubber Cement
- Scotch Tape
- Goo Be Gone
- Non Acid-Free Paper

You convinced me, Judy—no more rubber cement for me!!!!!

She polished off her presentation with a nice list of websites:

Websites

- www.mdStamp.com
  Potomac Supplies
- www.subwaystamp.com
- www.StampParaphernalia.com
- MysticStamp.com
- eBay.com
- www.linns.com

The presentation was very interesting and informational, but what I found the most entertaining aspect of the program was that she encouraged comments from other members in the club. Those discussions were very illuminating as well.

Thank you, Judy, it was a most enjoyable evening.

Yours in philately, Pat Richmond

"Ph"eatured "Ph"ilatelist Richard Spies

Richard Spies was born on August 28,????. (What's the matter, Richard—you can't remember or don't want to!) Anyway, he was born at home in Yoakum, Texas. He grew up in Yoakum and graduated from Yoakum High School in 1943. In May of 1943 he went to work for Tex-Tanning Manufacturing. He was a Leather Hand Tooler until January of 1945.

He went into the Army in 1945 at Ft. Bliss in El Paso and spent his 19th birthday on a troup train in Southern Arizona in the dark. He went to Ft. Ord, California to go overseas to the Phillipines.

In September, 1945, he was on a ship built for the Danish by the Germans that was confiscated in Australia by the United States and turned into a troop ship to take soldiers to the Phillipines. Was this international or what? He was in the Phillipines for 6 weeks.

Then in December of 1945, he boarded an LST (Landing Ship Tank) and went to Yokohama via Sendai, Japan and was assigned to Military Escort Co. (8th Army Stockade) that housed GI court-marshaled prisoners. In April of 1946, the unit was moved from Yokohama to Tokyo. In September of 1946, he came back to the states and was discharged in November, 1946.

He enrolled in Baldwin's Business College in Yoakum, Texas in 1947. He took normal business courses where you progressed mostly at your own speed. He finished in 8 months. He took the Post Office exam in June 1947. He was hired at Yoakum in October, 1947. At first, he was a substitute clerk/carrier and "Jack-of-all-trades". In February, 1951 he got an inner-agency transfer to the Railway Mail Service where he continued to be a substitute clerk. His first run was from San Antonio to Laredo and he said it made him "sick as a horse."

He got his 1st regular assignment in February 1952 on the Falfurrias to Skidmore run. He sorted and dispatched the mail. In December of 1952, however, they discontinued the Railway Post Office and established the Hiway Post Office. They discontinued the Hiway Post Office in 1970.

He moved back to San Antonio in 1966. After 1970, he spent the rest of his postal time at the Harry Brown Annex in San Antonio, Texas. He retired from the Postal Service in December, 1972.

Since Richard's retirement from the Postal Service he has been very active. In January of 1973, he became an officer on the Counsel in St. Luke's Lutheran Church. (We all know how much he has been a part of his church!!) He worked with the Boy Scouts from February, 1973 until 1995. He has been volunteering at the Institute of Texan Cultures since 1981. He takes care of the post office there every Tuesday. (Our last Philatex was cancelled there—thanks, Richard.)

In 1932, Richard's granddad got a lottery letter from Havana, Cuba. It had a very interesting stamp on it. And, TaDa! a Philatelist was born. As "they" say, the rest is history!

Richard calls himself a "Junk Collector". Among his "JUNK!!!" we have seen Rocket Mail, Postal Cancels, and Texas Pre-Cancels. What I did not know is that he started on a *Scott's International World Wide Album* in the 1950's and it is nearly full. What else are you hiding in your "junk pile", Richard?

He has been a member of the Mobil Post Office Society since the 50s. He joined the TPA in 1956. He joined the Texas Postal History Society in the early 60s and joined SAPA in 1966. He is a life member of SAPA.

Richard, you have had a very interesting and unique life. I personally have enjoyed your company for many years. You are a constant source of knowledge and information. You are also an accomplished "punster!". Thanks for being a member of SAPA.

Yours in Philately, Pat Richmond

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Fred says: We have received a nice note from a member who is asking for help. The member is unable to come to meetings and requests someone to come to his house here in San Antonio to catalogue his collection. He is willing to pay for this assistance. Interested persons can contact Treasurer Fred Groth at the club or at his e-mail **LTC519@satx.rr.com**

APS Releases New Stamps of Texas Album The American Philatelic Society is pleased to offer a 16-page *Stamps of Texas* album. It was created to celebrate APS AmeriStamp Expo/TEXPEX 2009, which will take place February 20-22 at the Arlington Convention Center in Arlington, Texas. The mini-album showcases United States stamps and a postal card related to the Lone Star State and its colorful history. Created for free use in the public domain — with generous permission from Scott Publishing Co. to use its copyrighted catalogue numbers — it is available as a pdf file that can be viewed or downloaded at http://www.stamps.org/Albums/Texas.pdf.

The *Stamps of Texas* album is number 3 in an ongoing series, following *Stamps of North Carolina* and *Stamps of Connecticut*. Future albums are planned for Arizona, and in conjunction with 2009–2011 APS shows in Pennsylvania, Virginia, California, South Carolina, and Ohio. All APS albums are available online at http://www.stamps.org/Education/edu_AlbumPages.htm.

More information about the APS AmeriStamp Expo/TEXPEX 2009 in Arlington is available at http://www.stamps.org/AmeriStamp/Index.htm.

For the complete article go to http://www.stamps.org/news/P1624.htm

CHRISTMAS
PARTY
2008
FOOD, FUN,
FRIENDSHIP